

Claude Cheat Sheet: 8th Grade US History

You don't need to learn any tool names. Open Claude, type what you need in plain English, and add the details below. Claude picks the right helper on its own.

The Formula

What you need + grade and topic + how long + who's in the room + what you want back. The more of these you give, the better the first draft.

Copy-and-Paste Prompts (edit the parts in brackets)

1. Lesson plan.

Plan a [45]-minute lesson for [7th] grade US history on [the causes of the Stamp Act protests]. Use 2 or 3 primary sources and end with a quick check for understanding.

2. Primary sources.

Find or suggest 3 primary sources on [the Boston Massacre] and simplify them for a [7th]-grade reading level. Keep the original meaning and point of view.

3. Different levels.

Here is my lesson [paste it]. Make three versions: below grade level, on level, and advanced. Keep the same content in all three.

4. Big question.

Here is my question for the unit: "[Why did the colonies rebel?]". Is it a good question for students to investigate with evidence? How could I improve it?

5. Rubric or writing help.

Make a rubric for a one-page argument essay on [whether the Boston Tea Party was justified]. Add a sentence-starter sheet for students who struggle.

6. Quiz or warm-up.

Write 8 quick review questions on [the 13 colonies: New England, Middle and Southern regions]. Mix easy and harder ones and include an answer key.

7. Parent email.

Write a short, friendly email to a parent about [missing assignments]. Keep it factual and offer a next step. Here are the details: [details, no last names].

8. Feedback on student work.

Write feedback for this student paragraph [paste it]. Name one strength and one next step, in language an 8th grader will understand.

Good Habits

- **Skip student names and personal details.** Say "a student" or use initials.
- **Check facts and dates yourself.** Claude can be wrong about history details, and it can make up quotes and sources. Confirm anything you'll put in front of students.
- **Check your state's standards.** Ask Claude to align to them, then confirm the wording against your state's official list.

- **Edit the draft.** Reply with "shorter," "add a group activity," or "make it more engaging." You don't need a new prompt each time.
- **Start a new chat for each new task.** It keeps things clean.

If Something Looks Off

Say what's wrong in plain words ("this is too long," "the sources are too hard"). If it still isn't right, ask *[your name]*.